Brad looked at me with a wild surmise and said, "Where are the passages you're speaking of?"

I showed them to him and he went through them and put back all the adverbs. It didn't do any good— The New Yorker never picked it up.

While there, I outlined the plot of a new novel, and he told me to go ahead. He wanted the first two chapters and an outline before writing a contract.

I found things going well when I returned to Boston. On November 9, there came news that Lemon had already obtained a renewal of his grant, so I was assured of a salary for a second year. Things seemed to be going far better than they had under Elderfield.

Besides which, I now made the discovery that books, unlike magazine stories, made money by themselves while the authors slept or dallied or twiddled their fingers. That same day I got a telegram from Fred Pohl to the effect that Unicorn Press, a small book club specializing in mysteries, had taken Pebble in the Sky for an advance of $1,000. Such earnings were split half and half between publisher and author, with Fred taking his agent's 10 per cent of my half, but that

still meant $450 for me eventually when it came to statement time. 2 Well, goodness, that was half a year's rent and I hadn't had to do any work for it at all.

This was the kind of inspiration to get me right to work by November 15 on the summary of a new novel, The Stars, like Dust—. I started the novel itself on the twentieth.

This is not to say that this new variety of writing success didn't bring some problems in its wake. At about this time, I received a copy of the book jacket for the forthcoming Pebble in the Sky. I was delighted, especially with my own handsome dream-prince of a photograph.

The back cover, in addition to the photo, had a biographical sketch, and the last sentence was, "Dr. Asimov lives in Boston, where he is engaged in cancer research at Boston University School of Medicine."

It had never occurred to me that the Medical School might be mentioned and now I wondered if the school might be offended by this. It was too late to change the jacket and I was not of a mind to hang by my thumbs and wait for an explosion. I thought I would have to confront the issue now and I already